

Hande Sodaci, PhD

Behavioral Scientist | Data-Driven Experimentation | Human–AI Interaction Researcher

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SUMMARY

Behavioral scientist with 10+ years designing controlled experiments and translating complex behavioral data into clear, actionable insight. Skilled in experimental design, statistical modeling, and iterating on protocols based on results with daily hands-on use of AI tools (ChatGPT, Claude) for analysis and iteration, and a sharp eye for what makes content and design actually work.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Product & User Research: User and interaction studies; experimental design; behavioral research; survey and task design; user feedback analysis; human–AI interaction.

Data & Experimentation: Behavioral data analysis; hypothesis testing; regression; statistical modeling; data visualization; reproducible analysis workflows.

Product Insight: Translating user behavior and research findings into actionable insights; identifying interaction patterns and friction points; evaluating user responses to system feedback and failures.

AI & Creative Tools: Daily use of ChatGPT and Claude for analysis, research, writing, and iterative workflows.

Tools: Data Analysis & Visualization (R; Excel; Google Sheets; SPSS; JASP); Research & Data Collection (Qualtrics; OpenSesame); Visual Communication & Prototyping (Canva; HTML/CSS); HRI & Robotics (Choregraphe).

Collaboration: Cross-functional research coordination; stakeholder communication; project coordination; documentation; research presentation.

Languages: Turkish (native); English (fluent).

EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Researcher @ Koç University, Istanbul

Sep 2020 – Aug 2026

- Designed controlled experiments manipulating listener identity and feedback signals and measuring their effect on user behavior — the core experimental logic behind A/B and multivariate testing, applied to human-robot interaction rather than a live product.
- Led end-to-end behavioral research spanning 200+ participants and more than 6,000 individual responses: protocol design, robot interaction programming, participant data management, and reproducible R pipelines.
- Used statistical modeling to detect real-time shifts in user behavior in response to system feedback.
- Translated complex behavioral findings into clear, actionable insight for technical and non-technical audiences through slide decks, research posters, and presentation design for academic and professional venues.

Editorial Assistant @ European Open Science, Remote

Jul 2023 – May 2025

- Managed the editorial workflow for 15 academic journals, covering submission checks, revision tracking, copyediting, production, and publication, as primary contact for authors.
- Maintained consistent documentation and process standards across concurrent journal pipelines.

Project Coordinator @ MEF University, Istanbul

Jul 2020 – Jan 2022

- Coordinated operations for a grant-funded longitudinal study (TÜBİTAK 1003), managing research staff, data-collection workflows, and partner-institution communication, and standardizing documentation across collaborating institutions.

Research Assistant @ Tilburg University, Netherlands

Feb 2017 – Feb 2018

- Designed and ran a personalized language-learning study for Turkish–Dutch bilingual children using a NAO social robot with tablet-based interaction, as part of the EU Horizon 2020 [L2tor](#) project.
- Worked with Tilburg and Utrecht teams to localize the system and integrate child-development and interaction requirements into the learning task.

EDUCATION

Associate Degree, AI-Assisted Coding, Anadolu University

Starting Oct 2026

Doctor of Philosophy, Psychology (Cognitive Track), Koç University, Istanbul

Sep 2020 – Aug 2026

Associate Degree, Web Design and Coding, Anadolu University

Sep 2019 – Jun 2021

Research Master, Language and Communication, Radboud University, Nijmegen

Sep 2016 – Aug 2018

Bachelor of Arts, Psychology, with Certificate in Linguistics, Boğaziçi University, Istanbul

Sep 2011 – Jun 2016

AWARDS & TRAINING

IEEE Robotics & Automation Society Travel Support Award

2026

[Data Analysis School](#) – Artificial Intelligence Track, YÖK & Marmara University

2026

TÜBİTAK 2211-A National PhD Scholarship

2020 – 2024

Holland Scholarship, Dutch Ministry of Education, Culture and Science

2016 – 2018